

Transportation Security Administration Requirements and Capabilities Analysis

On-Person Screening and Alarm Resolution

**Broad Agency Announcement (BAA)
70T04026BAA7573N001**

Section A: General Information

A.1 Introduction

This announcement is being made to support the Transportation Security Administration (TSA), Requirements and Capabilities Analysis (RCA), Capabilities Management and Modernization division (CM&M) to open a BAA 70T04026BAA7573N001. The TSA RCA is interested in receiving concept papers for development projects that support the TSA mission of ensuring the safety and freedom of movement for people and commerce. To achieve its mission, the TSA seeks development opportunities across targeted strategic areas related to On-Person Screening (OPS) and Alarm Resolution (AR) processes for potential advancement and improvement to strengthen the agency's ability to respond to shifting adversarial threats, detect emerging and evolving threats concealed on-person, and enable efficient and effective targeting of screening resources. The TSA is specifically interested in development that will provide for near term improvement of current security operations and capabilities, as aligned with RCA's OPS and AR Roadmaps, by addressing several Technical Topic Areas (TTAs) in two submission tracks as shown below and further defined in Section B.

OPS

Track 01

- TTA- 01, Limited Mobility
- TTA- 02, Footwear Screening
- TTA- 03, Touchless Resolution
- TTA- 04, Emerging On-Person Technologies

AR

Track 02

- TTA- 05, Tabletop X-Ray Diffraction for Alarm Resolution

This document supports a BAA as contemplated under the RFO 35.102. Contracts and/or Agreements based on responses to this BAA are considered to be the result of full and open competition and in full compliance with the provisions of Public Law (PL) 98-369, "The Competition in Contracting Act of 1984."

TSA will not issue paper copies of this announcement. TSA reserves the right to select for award and fund all, some, or none of the submissions received in response to this Window. TSA will not provide funding or reimbursement for proposal development costs. Full submissions or any other

material submitted in response to this BAA will not be returned. All submissions shall be unclassified.

The TSA is soliciting concept papers which will be evaluated in accordance with this BAA and if selected by the applicable TSA RCA Capability Manager (CM), will be submitted for consideration on the TSA RCA spend plan for the current fiscal year. If funding is provided on the spend plan, the TSA Contracting Officer (CO) will request a full proposal from the offeror; if that full proposal is found acceptable to RCA's needs, the CO may initiate negotiations for a contract award or execute a bailment agreement to test solutions as discussed in the following sections.

Offerors who submit concept papers that have no direct application to the TTAs listed in this BAA will be rejected. Concept papers must present a coherent concept/detailed plan for accomplishing the objectives of the RCA OPS and/or AR mission to continue to the final review and potential contract award.

A.2 Additional BAA Instructions

Work funded under a BAA may include applied research, advanced technology development, prototyping, pilot demonstrations, and testing. RFO Part 35 restricts the use of funding in cases such as this to the acquisition of basic and applied research and that portion of advanced technology development not related to the development of a specific system or hardware procurement. Procurement instruments awarded under this BAA are strictly for those purposes; directed towards advancing the state of the art and increasing knowledge or understanding related to transportation security. Specifically, this BAA is not for the acquisition of technical, engineering, and other types of support services, nor is it for the acquisition of development or production of specific programs or objectives. The TSA will not accept or consider submissions of concept papers that are similar to or identical to the TSA's or the Department of Homeland Security Science & Technology (DHS S&T) Directorate's on-going/completed efforts, or on-going/planned acquisitions. The TSA reserves the right to decline submissions that were previously proposed to the TSA or to DHS S&T and declined. The TSA reserves the right to decline submissions to the BAA if the submissions are identical to submissions currently undergoing evaluation by the TSA or DHS S&T. TSA works very closely with DHS S&T and other federal agencies on matters of research and development.

Technologies that have attained a Technology Readiness Level (TRL) [as defined in Appendix 1 of this BAA] 5 or higher for Track 01 and TRL 4 or higher for Track 02 and/or breadboard validation in a relevant environment is the minimum scope of the BAA. Submissions without a clear path to practical TSA applications within twelve (12) to eighteen (18) months will be declined. In addition, submissions whose sole purpose is to request an evaluation of a product (both new and old) will not be considered for award under this BAA. TSA will accept concept papers containing commercial services and items as long as the proposed concepts are consistent with the development opportunity description found within this BAA.

The TSA is seeking to accelerate the design, realization and delivery of new capabilities to the field. Concept papers that align closely with the strategic direction, investment priorities and details of this BAA will have a higher likelihood of being selected.

The TSA reserves the right to reject submissions that meet the objectives of the RCA OPS

and/or AR roadmaps and/or mission covered by this BAA, but do not meet current TSA mission needs as determined by the TSA or whose estimated cost exceeds current budget constraints.

Section B: BAA Objectives

B.1 Background

B.1.1 OPS Requirements/Objectives (Track 01)

- TTA- 01, Limited Mobility
 - Ability to effectively screen individuals in wheelchairs for metallic and non-metallic threats without touching the passenger.
 - Ability for the screening method to be completed in under 30 seconds.
- TTA- 02, Footwear Screening
 - Ability to screen footwear (soles included) for metallic and non-metallic threats while passengers keep footwear on.
 - Ability to be integrated into current screening process with no additional steps to initiate scan.
- TTA- 03, Touchless Resolution
 - Ability to effectively resolve on-person alarms without requiring a pat-down of the area alarmed.
 - Ability for the screening method to be resolved in under 5 seconds.
- TTA- 04, Emerging On-Person Technologies
 - Any technology solution that would increase efficiency in the screening process and/or enhance the passenger experience.

B.1.2 AR Requirements/Objectives (Track 02)

- TTA- 05, Tabletop X-Ray Diffraction for Alarm Resolution
 - Ability to use X-Ray Diffraction to effectively screen objects that completely or partially block the passage of radiant energy while at the same time blocking physical access to the material causing the primary screening alarm.
 - Ability to use X-Ray Diffraction technology in a tabletop configuration.

TSA must ensure that its security screening checkpoints are both effective and efficient. A critical aspect of checkpoint screening is making sure that all individuals seeking entry to the airport sterile area are screened for person-borne threats to aviation. These include explosives, non-explosive prohibited items, and chemical, biological, radiological, and nuclear (CBRN) threats. TSA is continuously evaluating and modernizing the OPS processes to strengthen the agency's ability to respond to shifting adversarial threats, detect emerging and evolving threats concealed on-person, and enable efficient and effective targeting of screening resources. The Aviation and Transportation Security Act of 2001 directs TSA to screen all passengers and property that will be carried aboard a passenger aircraft. Accordingly, TSA recognizes two (2) categories of individuals under the Screen People mission area. They are:

1. **Travelers/Non-Traveling Individuals** are those who are screened at a TSA security

checkpoint for items not permitted aboard a passenger aircraft. **Travelers** are defined as boarding pass holders and working crew members authorized to enter the sterile area to travel on a passenger aircraft and listed on the flight manifest. A **Non-Traveling Individual** is an individual to whom a covered aircraft operator seeks to issue an authorization to enter the sterile area of an airport for a purpose permitted by the TSA, such as to escort a minor or a passenger with disabilities.

2. **Aviation Workers** are defined as employees, contractors, or representatives of an airport, domestic or foreign airline, concessionaire, tenant, government agency (Federal, State, local, or tribal), entity in the air cargo supply chain, or other entity working or operating at an airport regulated under 49 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) part 1542. An **Aviation Worker** may be required to pass through a TSA screening checkpoint or may be permitted to use another sterile area entry point subject to **Aviation Worker** screening standards, depending on the airport operator's security plan and access privileges granted to the individual.

TSA's OPS activities are focused on improving, acquiring, and deploying capabilities and technologies to enhance the operational efficiency and security effectiveness of on-person screening.

Currently, to meet TSA's screening objectives, OPS screening systems require divestiture of a person's outerwear prior to being screened. Similarly, when an individual triggers an alarm during screening, a pat-down typically is required to resolve the alarm, which is uncomfortable to many individuals. Both the divestiture of a person's outerwear and pat-downs for alarm resolution increase the time required to screen passengers and often increase passenger wait times.

RCA's role in TSA's acquisition of transportation security equipment (TSE) includes identifying needs, defining user objectives, analyzing alternatives, and demonstrating new capabilities/solutions. Technology solutions borne from these activities may be procured by the Government or obtained by other aviation stakeholders. This approach requires an architecture and solution set that is flexible and involves significant work in the areas of objectives definition, policy development, test and evaluation, and compliance. The potential technology solutions defined, evaluated, and planned with the support defined in this BAA must at minimum:

3. Align to ongoing plans for integrating checkpoint OPS and AR systems with other checkpoint systems
4. Maintain the checkpoint's robust cybersecurity posture
5. Promote connectivity, modularity, and open architecture to support enhancements (e.g., 3rd party algorithms, common interfaces, standardized data formats, etc.)
6. Improve the security effectiveness of OPS and AR
7. Reduce manpower requirements at the checkpoint
8. Accelerate the screening process timeline for passengers

B.2 Opportunity Description

In a diverse and rapidly evolving threat environment, TSA's security effectiveness strategies must achieve maximum future-state efficiency. To enable this mission objective, TSA and the CM for

OPS and AR are looking to establish the next generation of OPS and AR solutions with a focus on moving passengers through the checkpoint in a continuous manner, enhancing threat detection capabilities with reduced false alarm rates, installing display image standardization, and enabling operational connectivity through secure data transmission. With these objectives, TSA OPS and AR will advance the checkpoint towards a future state of continuous screening, improving threat detection, and ensuring compatibility across screening checkpoints.

The following sections set forth specific tasks related to the TTAs. The identified tasks for the TTAs presented herein have a direct impact on meeting the objectives outlined in the Aviation and Transportation Security Act of 2001, PL 107-71. The TSA seeks to mature threat detection technology and deliver aviation security checkpoint screening equipment and solutions that may be acquired by subsequent TSA programs.

To achieve these goals, TSA has defined the five (5) TTAs listed above. Concept papers must address at least one of these TTAs for consideration and evaluation.

B.3 Project Management and Support (Applicable to all TTAs)

B.3.1 Project Management and Support

TSA is not providing a separate monetary award for Project Management and Support. The Project Management and Support is considered as Not Separately Priced (NSP); if a concept paper is selected and a proposal is requested as a result of this BAA as outlined in Section C, the Contractor will be required to include the elements outlined below in sections B.3.1.1 through B.3.1.6 to perform project support activities and complete deliverables to enable project progress and milestone achievements. The Contractor shall maintain the formal organization to continue the project support and management to efficiently and effectively execute the objectives outlined in sections B.3.1.1 through B.3.1.6.

B.3.1.1 Post-Award Conference

A post-award conference will be conducted at a site specified by the Government within ten (10) business days after award. The TSA will designate Government conference attendees and will identify any unique conference support objectives. The Government will develop an agenda and the Contractor shall provide the draft minutes for the conference for TSA review and approval within two (2) business days after the conference.

During the post-award conference, the Contractor shall be prepared to address, at a minimum, a review and status of the following topics:

- Overview of the deliverable submissions status
- Invoicing procedures
- Project schedule with milestones
- Organizational status
- Cost, schedule, and performance (technical) aspects of the SOW
- Subcontractor's technical progress on all assigned tasks (if applicable)
- Lines of communication

B.3.1.2 Status Tracking and Reporting

The Contractor shall be responsible for project management throughout the entire project period of performance. The Contractor shall provide all labor, materials, planning, managing, and the equipment necessary to complete the tasks for design, development, integration, and/or testing objectives in accordance with this BAA and all applicable State and Federal codes and laws. The Contractor shall identify a Project Manager who shall be the Contractor's focal point for all required security technology related project tasks. The Project Manager can also be a technical lead on the project, thus wearing multiple hats in performing contractual tasks.

The Contractor shall perform monthly project status tracking and reporting, project management reviews, and technical interchanges during the life of the contract. An annual technical report will be provided to TSA covering all technical aspects of the project. These meetings will occur mostly via teleconference; however, they can be in person at a location as directed by the Government CO or Contracting Officer's Representative (COR).

If required, the Contractor will support Project Management Reviews (PMRs) where the project status is discussed in depth, and further discussion can take place on issues most critical at the time. A Technical Interchange Meeting (TIM) can be called by the CO, COR, or Contractor to discuss design updates and/or evaluate merits of proposed technical changes. PMRs and TIMs can satisfy status reporting and the CO or COR may cancel the regular project status reporting as a result.

The Government will develop an agenda and the Contractor shall provide the draft minutes for the meeting for TSA review and approval within two (2) business days after the meeting.

The Contractor shall be responsible for identifying and obtaining all required and necessary badges/permissions needed to accomplish installation requirements throughout all associated project phases and for all required labor personnel.

B.3.1.3 Project Risk Management

The Contractor shall identify cost, schedule, and technical risks and describe how it will effectively manage these risks throughout the period of performance of the work.

The Contractor shall develop and maintain a list identifying, analyzing, classifying, and prioritizing project risks and a recommended course of action to address those risks. Project risks shall be classified as low, medium, or high priority and include supplier risks. The Contractor shall conduct risk mitigation and contingency planning for risks considered medium or high priority.

The Contractor shall quantify risks with respect to their impact on integration, installation, design, performance, technical parameters, schedule, cost, manufacturing, and maintainability of existing prototype fleet. Risks will be included on the status reports and regularly updated and discussed in detail with the CO or COR at least once per quarter.

B.3.1.4 General Test and Evaluation Support

In support of any Contractor's internal testing and Government laboratory and field testing for the development and completion of the work, the Contractor shall:

- Plan, communicate, and conduct Contractor tests
- Support Government-conducted testing and continuous assessment
- Prepare and deliver all scan and test plans, training sets (for machine learning algorithms), procedures, necessary Government forms, and report results and associated deliverables for each test activity as required or directed by the COR.

The Contractor shall maintain a single point of contact (POC) as the lead for all testing activities related to this SOW. The single POC shall deliver and/or receive all test reports and schedules to/from the Government as required and participate in technical meetings. Additionally, this single POC shall be responsible for coordinating all test activities and shall relay pertinent reports and schedules to the site-specific project managers and internal Contractor stakeholders as required.

The Contractor shall:

- Provide the necessary test equipment and ensure its availability, proper calibration, fully operational status, and operation as documented by the test equipment manufacturer.
- Obtain prior written approval from the Government before using unique or modified commercial test equipment not specified in the approved test plans and procedures.
- Provide the Government, if asked, with the proof of proper calibration of test equipment provided by the Contractor.
- Conduct, or support the Government in conducting, a Test Readiness Notification (TRN) and Test Readiness Review (TRR) prior to performing any formal test.
- Notify the Government at least ten (10) business days prior to commencement of all formal Contractor conducted Acceptance Testing and permit the Government to witness the test.
- Perform all data collection and analysis associated with Contractor testing and furnish original data and analysis methods and results to support claims of Test and Evaluation (T&E) success. If requested by the Government, the Contractor shall provide the data collection report, inclusive of data, methods and results, within fifteen (15) business days after the completion of a Government-directed and Contractor-conducted test.

The Contractor shall record all inputs, outputs, and test results as described in any approved test plans and/or procedures. Anomalies, test deviations, test equipment substitutions, members of the test team, any other significant events, and the start and stop time for each test shall be documented.

The TRN is a notification from the Contractor to the Government stating that the system will be ready for testing on the specified date. The Contractor shall provide the Government a TRN at least ten (10) business days prior to conducting each formal test. A formal test includes any test that the Government deems as formal and demonstrates operational capabilities to verify machine (hardware and/or software) functionality. TRN shall be submitted via email to the Government COR and any other representative as designated by the CO.

The TRR is a formal review of the Contractor's software or equipment, as specified in the TRN, and related documentation to verify readiness for test. The Contractor shall conduct a TRR and submit the TRN to the COR and/or designated Government representative at least ten (10) business days prior to conducting each formal test. The Contractor shall submit these documents via email to the Government COR and any other representative as designated by the CO. If requested by the Government, a Verification Requirements Traceability Matrix (VRTM) shall be included in a test plan or procedure, clearly listing each specification and lower-level derived requirement to be verified in that test with a reference to the appropriate requirement paragraph, including test location and test method.

The Contractor shall support Government-conducted test events at Government test facilities (such as the Transportation Security Laboratory (TSL)) with or without representative field operators in the intended operational environment, or at an Operational Demonstration site when directed by the Government. These events may include integration testing or conducting integration Site Acceptance Testing (iSAT) for capabilities developed and deployed under this SOW such as automated screening lanes or networking. The Government will conduct laboratory testing and/or an Operational Demonstration on OPS or AR systems with new or updated algorithms, to include various configurations and/or software and hardware components desired by the Government, to assess operational effectiveness and suitability of the algorithms and/or any proposed software or hardware modifications or integration. The level of testing effort will be determined by the Government. The Contractor shall support the Government's developmental testing by providing at a minimum the following support as directed by Government:

- Attend and participate in on-site planning meetings and test preparation at the designated test sites
- Prepare, review with the Government, and deliver applicable test plans
- Conduct operator training and provide updated operational manuals
- Provide on-site technical support
- Support configuration management activities as required
- Assist with all data collection, including interpretation/analysis of Field Data Reporting System (FDRS) data

The Contractor shall provide a schedule outlining the following milestones and deliverables to support general T&E activities as listed below:

- Kickoff Review and Schedule
- Test Plan
- Test Readiness Review
- Preliminary Design Review (PDR)
- Critical Design Review (CDR)
- System Design Document
- Close Out Presentation / Stage Gate – Determine Execution of Option Period, if applicable
- Final Technical Report

The scope will include a Government evaluation of technical reports and/or briefings through System Design Reviews (e.g., System Concept Reviews [SCR], Preliminary Design Reviews

[PDR], Critical Design Reviews [CDR]), test plans, test results, and other design documentation). The Government reserves the right to witness all Contractor-conducted test activities. The Contractor(s) shall provide the Government written notice at least ten (10) business days prior to conducting testing.

B.3.1.5 Configuration Management

The Contractor is responsible for meeting configuration control requirements as documented under TSA's Configuration Management Plan for OAPM (Attachment 3) and as applicable to the developmental systems and environments in accordance with this BAA. The Contractor is required to maintain its Configuration Management Program established under the contract and to manage the configuration baselines established for all equipment purchased.

The outline below provides key terminologies to establish common understandings for specific TSA Configuration Management artifacts:

- **CSAR - The Configuration Status Accounting Report (CSAR)** provides text and (marked-up) technical documents (e.g., specifications, engineering drawings) that identify discrepancies between the material (including software) and the requirements delineated in the applicable technical documents. Depending on the type of audit, the identified discrepancies may be attributable to the material, the technical documents, or both.
- **MCIL - The Master Configuration Item List (MCIL)** establishes and maintains the definitive, current basis for control and status accounting of a system and its designated hardware, software, and firmware configuration items (CI) throughout their lifecycle that are being developed for and/or used in the TSA security system inventory. This information is needed to manage and support those items during their lifecycle.
- **DEP - A Deviated Engineering Proposal (DEP)** describes a proposed (prior to manufacture) departure from configuration documentation for a specific number of units or for a specified period of time. A DEP enables the Government to determine the impact on performance, operational readiness, logistics support or other affected areas.
- **ECP - An Engineering Change Proposal (ECP)** includes both the engineering change and the documentation by which the change is described and suggested. It describes changes to configuration items and associated configuration documentation that are affected by the proposed engineering change.

The Contractor shall make available the following required documents as evidence of maintaining the baseline:

- CSAR
- MCIL
- Design documents
- Engineering drawings
- Bill of Materials (BOM)
- Source code documents
- Product data sheets
- Software release notes
- Approved Change Requests

The Contractor shall retain all documentation for identification, control and status accounting of any CI throughout the program life cycle. The CI identification shall be available in the MCIL and provided on a monthly basis. The Contractor shall apply configuration change management measures to each baseline CI and its configuration documentation. The Contractor's configuration change management system shall provide effective means, as applicable, for proposing changes to CIs and ensuring implementation of the approved change. The Contractor shall maintain configuration change management of hardware; software; firmware; and developmental, commercial, and training documentation. The Contractor shall maintain configuration change management of hardware to the Lowest Replaceable Unit (LRU) level and software to the version level.

Change requests represent opportunities for improvement or correction of deficiencies and must be documented and submitted to the Government for review and approval. Desired changes are documented in Requests for Change (RFC) in the form of ECPs or DEPs. All change requests shall be entered, tracked, controlled, and documented by the Contractor.

The Contractor shall support Government-conducted Functional Configuration Audits (FCA) and Physical Configuration Audits (PCA) on the equipment purchased under this contract, as needed. The FCA shall verify system functional performance requirements. Upon successful completion of the FCA, a PCA will be performed. The PCA shall verify system physical performance requirements.

B.3.1.6 Project Management and Support Deliverables

Table 1 outlines expected milestones and deliverables for the Project Management and Support

Table 1: Milestones and Deliverables for Project Management and Support

Section #	Deliverable	Frequency of Delivery (business days)
B.3.1.1	Post Award Conference (PAC) and Materials	One, within ten (10) days after award
B.3.1.2	Status Calls and Reporting Materials	Monthly, as needed, per CO and/or COR
B.3.1.2	Project Management Review (PMR)	Monthly, as needed, per CO and/or COR
B.3.1.2	Technical Interchange Meeting (TIM)	As needed, per CO and/or COR or Contractor
B.3.1.2	Presentation Materials	Five (5) days prior to PAC, PMRs, TIMs, or other major meetings
B.3.1.2	Meeting Minutes	Two (2) days after PAC, Status Calls, PMRs, TIMs, or other major meetings
B.3.1.3	Risk Reports	Quarterly and updated in status calls
B.3.1.4	Test and Evaluation Schedule	Recurring on a bi-weekly cadence
B.3.1.4	Test Readiness Notification (TRN)	Recurring based on testing
B.3.1.4	Test Readiness Review (TRR)	Recurring based on testing
B.3.1.4	Preliminary Design Review (PDR)	Three (3) months after review
B.3.1.4	Critical Design Review (CDR)	Six (6) months after review
B.3.1.4	System Design Document	One, within two (2) weeks of contract closeout
B.3.1.4	Final/Annual Technical Report	One, annually
B.3.1.5	Configuration Management	Monthly, as needed to be directed by CO and COR

B.4 Cybersecurity and Network Compliance (Applicable to both Tracks)

TSA is interested in OPS and AR solutions that can function in an interoperable and networked environment with the ability to align and be compliant with current DHS and TSA Enterprise Architecture and the Federal Enterprise Architecture Framework requirements. OPS and AR capabilities and systems need to meet current TSA Information Technology (IT) security requirements.

TSA is interested in OPS and AR concepts that can achieve the following:

- Support networked "reach back" to TSOs in the field.
- Achieve compliance with current cybersecurity standards in accordance with requirements. For example, does the proposed solution:
 - Meet the seventeen (17) pillars of cybersecurity
 - <https://sam.gov/opp/fdc87793ced04442b8a34cd6a913749f/view>
 - Incorporate cybersecurity measures to discriminate access-levels of the operators.
 - Allow tracking of operator log-ins/decisions.

Section C: Submission Information

C.1 Submission and Award Information

C.1.1 Award Timeline

The following is a tentative award schedule for submission in FY26. Review the Sam.gov announcement site for updates.

Activity	Date
Announcement Released	4/29/2026
Concept Paper Questions Due	5/11/2026
Concept Paper Submissions Due	5/29/2026
Questions to Vendors (If Applicable)	6/05/2026
Full Proposal Submissions	6/26/2026
Estimated Contract Award	9/30/2026

C.1.2 Questions

All questions for this BAA must be electronically submitted to the BAA Contracting Officer (CO) at Siobhan.Mullen@tsa.dhs.gov and Matthew.Coniglio@tsa.dhs.gov, referencing the BAA number, title, and company name "OPS/AR BAA 70T04026BAA7573N001 [company]" no later than **2:00pm Eastern Time on May 11, 2026**. All communications shall be submitted via e-mail. Do not include any classified material or Sensitive Security Information (SSI) as defined in 49 CFR 1520. If Offerors must ask questions that contain classified material or SSI, please notify the BAA CO and additional instructions will be provided.

Answers to contractual questions related to this BAA will be addressed in the form of an Amendment and will be posted to the System for Award Management (SAM) webpage at <https://www.Sam.gov>. Answers to technical questions will be provided solely to the requester.

C.1.3 Submission Process

- Submission Window
 - The concept paper submission cutoff date for both Tracks – Separate submissions per TTA is **May 29, 2026 at 2:00pm Eastern Time.**
- Feasibility
 - Technical evaluators review concept papers and may provide questions to Offeror(s) for further clarification. The technical evaluators will select submissions for the RCA CMs to consider with the fiscal year's Spend Plan.
 - If selected ~~for funding~~, the Offeror may be either:
 - invited via email to submit a full proposal and if evaluated and chosen, begin contract negotiations with Contracting and Procurement. The full proposal due date and submission instructions will be specified in the email.
 - OR
 - requested to bail their solution to the Government at no cost to the Government to support TSA testing. Bailment Agreements will be executed upon selection and bailed solutions shall be delivered to TSA within ninety (90) days of agreement execution.

C.2 Submission Instructions

All concept paper submissions shall be sent electronically to the following email address of the Contracting Officer at Siobhan.Mullen@tsa.dhs.gov and Matthew.Coniglio@tsa.dhs.gov no later than 2:00pm Eastern Time on May 29, 2026. All concept paper submissions shall have a subject line of the email that reads "OPS/AR- BAA 70T04026BAA7573N001 Concept Paper" and include the TTA, company name and a short title of the concept.

Due to TSA restrictions on the size of email, ensure that all emails submitted are less than 5MB. If the submission exceeds 5MB, please divide into multiple emails and include in the subject line the title as detailed above and # of # emails. All submissions must be in Adobe, Microsoft Office formats (2007 or later); links to documents on a cloud platform will not be accepted by TSA and TSA may not further consider such submission for consideration.

Offerors shall be solely responsible for knowing the limitations of their internet service provider. Offerors are encouraged to compress (e.g., zip) or separate large files into a number of smaller files and, if necessary, submit them within multiple emails. Offerors may not submit proposals on CD-ROM or other electronic media. Offers submitted via facsimile or in hard copy format will not be considered.

Prior to any evaluation, the TSA will check all files for viruses and ensure that all information is readable. In the event any files are defective (unreadable), the TSA may only evaluate the readable electronic files. However, if the defective (unreadable) media renders a significant deficiency in the Offeror's submission, the TSA may consider the submission incomplete and may not further consider such submission for consideration.

The TSA will not award contracts on the basis of concept papers alone, and unsolicited full proposals will be rejected. Following an evaluation of submitted concept papers, the TSA may select Offerors to submit a full proposal and, if evaluated and chosen, enter negotiations for a contract award or request the Offeror to execute bailment agreements to test their proposed solution as outlined above.

Offers submitted under the BAA are expected to be unclassified. Proposal submissions will be protected from unauthorized disclosure in accordance with RFO 3.104-4 and applicable law/regulations. Offerors are expected to appropriately mark each page of their submission that contains proprietary information.

Offerors shall use a consistent title throughout the document which is descriptive of the work they cover and not merely a copy of the title of this announcement.

Concept papers must be in Adobe or Microsoft Word format (2007 or later); full proposals must be in Adobe or Microsoft Office formats (2007 or later), e.g., Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Project, etc. All pricing data shall be placed in Microsoft Excel (2007 or later) with formulas preserved. All concept papers and proposals shall be prepared to print on letter-sized paper (8 ½ inch x 11 inch), double-spaced, text only with foldouts as required. Each Offeror shall utilize Times New Roman 12-point font. Reduction may be used only for tables and figures and relevant captions. Margins shall not be less than one-inch at top, bottom and sides, excluding page number, "Page X of Y Pages" numbering, the proposed title of the project, the Offeror's name, and submission date in the footer of each page shall be used. All pages shall be sequentially numbered with no gaps, breaks, or sub-page numbers/letters.

Offers shall not exceed the specified page limitations stated below (cover letter and table of contents/proposal checklists will not be counted toward the specified page limits). The TSA reserves the right to not consider any pages in excess of the limitation for evaluation purposes. Offerors are also advised that the use of promotional material and/or brochures will not constitute compliance with the objectives concerning the content of responses.

C.3 Content and Format of Offers

The table below and the sections that follow identify the contents of each volume. Concept papers and full proposals **shall not contain or discuss Sensitive Security Information (SSI)**.

Volume	Contents	Page Limits
Concept Paper	Elements defined in Section C.3.1	15
	Factor 1- Entrance Criteria	

Full Proposals	Elements defined in Section C.3.2 Factor 2- Technical Approach Factor 3- Past Performance Factor 4- Price Other Submission Information	See Section C.3.2
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For Tracks 01 and 02, TSA will review submissions based on the following criteria in descending order of importance:

- Factor 1: Entrance Criteria (Concept Paper)
- Factor 2: Technical Approach (Full Proposal)
- Factor 3: Past Performance (Full Proposal)
- Factor 4: Price (Full Proposal)

Overall, the technical factors (1 – 3 above) are in descending order of importance and combined are more important than the price factor (4). Requirements will also be evaluated against TSA's available funds. The degree of importance of price will increase with the degree of equality of the proposals in relation to the other factors on which selection is to be based, or when the price is so significantly high as to diminish the value of the proposal's technical superiority to the Government.

Contract Type

The Government contemplates the award of firm fixed price (FFP) contract(s) and/or Bailment Agreement(s) to those offeror(s) whose submissions conform to this Announcement and represent an approach that is beneficial to the Government.

C.3.1.1 Submission Stages

Factor 1: Entrance Criteria (Concept Paper)

Concept Paper Submission – Both Tracks – One submission per TTA.

Information shall be provided by the offeror in the following order:

Offeror Name

Proposal Title (Include specific TTA number in front of title)

Estimated Price

Duration of Period of Performance (in months)

Technical Concept

Relevance to TSA's BAA TTA Objective(s) and Mission

Operational Utility Assessment Plan

List of Tasks

List of Deliverables

Technology Readiness Level (TRL)

Expected TSA Support

Key Dates / Milestones

Capabilities / Related Experience

Intellectual Property Data Rights

Amplified information requirements:

1. Offers Shall Include a Cover Letter for each TTA separately: The Cover letter shall be labeled, "CONCEPT PAPER" and shall include the BAA number "70T04026BAA7573N1", proposed title with specific TTA number, points of contact, address, telephone number, facsimile number, email address, corporate Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) number, Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) Code, Taxpayer Identification Number (ID) number, certifications required at RFO 52.209-5 Certification Regarding Responsibility Matters, (March 16, 2026); and the period of performance of the project in months. The Cover letter must also include the name and contact information for the individual authorized to negotiate and contractually obligate on behalf of the Offeror.

The Concept Paper shall have sections corresponding to and addressing the enumerated sections below:

2. Technical Concept: A description of the innovation, maturity of the concept/technology, technical risk areas, and proposed mitigation. The description should include the project objectives, the concept of operation for the new concept, and the expected operational performance improvements. The description should also include an estimation of the applicable concept/system specifications (e.g., weight, dimensions, probability of detection, probability of false alarm, throughput), limitations of concept, a declaration with a brief supporting statement of the current Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of the concept as well as the projected TRL of the concept at the end of the proposed period of performance.

3. Relevance to TSA's BAA TTA Objective(s) and Mission: A description of potential transportation security relevance and contributions of the effort to the agency's specific BAA TTA objective(s). A discussion of how this innovation meets the TSA's mission needs must be included.

4. Operational Utility Assessment Plan: A plan for demonstrating and evaluating the operational effectiveness of the Offeror's proposed concept in field experiments and/or tests in a simulated environment. This would be a description of how the concept can be proven or tested to demonstrate effectiveness.

5. List of Tasks: A description of specific tasks that would need to be accomplished in order to deliver the proposed concept.

6. List of Deliverables: A list of items that will become TSA property (e.g., prototypes, reports, test objects, consumables, etc.).

7. Expected TSA Support: A list of all tasks that will need the TSA's support to complete (e.g., access to Sensitive Security Information or classified information, Food and Drug Administration [FDA]/ National Institute of Standards and Technology [NIST] safety testing, Transportation Security Lab [TSL]/TSA Systems Integration Facility Source Selection Information TSIF/operational testing, etc.). The Offeror needs to list these tasks, identify the type of support needed, with a justification, and include the associated costs in the estimated price.

8. Key Dates/Milestones: A list of key dates from start through concept completion.

9. Estimated Price: A description of the funding required to procure the proposed completed concept, to include a breakdown of tasks necessary for development of the concept for completion.

10. Capabilities/Related Experience: A brief description of similar work performed, or qualifications related to the proposed concept/completed concept.

11. Intellectual Property (IP)/Data Rights: A summary of the intellectual property and data rights asserted.

Government Evaluation:

TSA will review the Offeror's concept paper to determine the overall scientific and technical merits and Technical Readiness Level (TRL), maturity of the concept/technology, evidence of the stated TRL 5 or higher for Track 01 and TRL 4 or higher for Track 02; the potential importance, relevance, and timeliness of the effort to the BAA TTA objective(s) and TSA/RCA mission; the Offeror's capabilities, the concept of operation for the new capabilities to be delivered, related experience, facilities, management capabilities (including key personnel), program plan (e.g., key milestones, list of tasks, and deliverables), techniques or unique combinations of these which are integral factors for achieving the proposal objectives; proposed prices; and availability of funds. In addition, TSA will assess the potential transportation security relevance and value added to the TSA's specific mission and the expected operational performance improvements, and the feasibility of achieving expected improvements considering project resources. Offerors that do not provide sufficient documentation will receive an 'Unacceptable' rating and be considered ineligible for the next phase and will not be evaluated further. The Government reserves the right to evaluate risks identified in an Offeror's concept paper to determine whether 'Acceptable' or 'Unacceptable'.

At the Government's discretion, if the TSA determines an Offeror's concept paper to be "acceptable" and there are available funds available, the TSA will notify the offeror and will request a proposal. For those offeror's concepts found to be "unacceptable" no further action will be requested and TSA will notify the officer of such.

Factor 2: Technical Approach (Full Proposal)

Proposal Submission Elements – Both Tracks – One submission per TTA:

The Offeror shall provide the following information in Sections 1 - 13 below to facilitate the Government's consideration of Factor 2. The Proposal shall have sections corresponding to and addressing these enumerated sections below:

Information shall be provided by the offeror in the following order:

1. Cover Letter
2. Table of Contents (Optional)
3. Table of Acronyms (Optional)
4. Statement of Work
5. Technical Approach and Justification
6. Government Furnished Information and Equipment
7. Relevance to TSA's BAA TTA Objectives and Mission
8. Operational Utility Assessment Plan
9. Expected TSA Support
10. Management Approach and Teaming Arrangements
11. Project Schedule and Milestones

12. Assertion of Data Rights and / or Rights in Computer Software
13. Deliverables / Reports

Amplified information requirements:

1. Cover Letter (for each TTA separately): The Cover letter shall be labeled, "PROPOSAL" and shall include the BAA number "70T04026BAA7573N1", proposed title with specific TTA number, points of contact, address, telephone number, facsimile number, email address, corporate Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) number, Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) Code, Taxpayer Identification Number (ID) number, certifications required at RFO 52.209-5, and the period of performance of the project in months. The Cover letter must also include the name and contact information for the individual authorized to negotiate and contractually obligate on behalf of the Offeror.
2. Table(s) of Contents: Optional section that includes one or more of the following: a hierarchical listing of sections and subsections of the document indexed by page number; a listing of the figures indexed by page numbers; and a listing of tables indexed by page numbers.
3. Table of Acronyms: Optional section that includes a table of acronyms that associates technical abbreviations with their unabbreviated forms.
4. Statement of Work: A SOW (at a minimum) clearly detailing the scope and objectives of the effort; a list and description of specific tasks that would need to be accomplished in order to deliver the proposed concept, clearly indicating those tasks which will require TSA support; a list of deliverables, to include a list of items that will become TSA property; list of milestones with acceptance criteria. This SOW should provide the details as to how the technical approach and concept outcome will be achieved. If awarded a contract, it is anticipated that the proposed SOW, with agreed upon revisions, will be incorporated as an attachment to the resultant award instrument. To this end, the proposals must be consistent with RFO Part 35 and include a severable, self-standing SOW, without any proprietary restrictions, which can be attached to the contract or agreement. Submission of the SOW without restrictive markings is the Offeror's affirmation that the SOW is non-proprietary and releasable in response to Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) requests.
5. Technical Approach and Justification: The major portion of the proposal should consist of the technical approach being proposed. This discussion should provide the technical foundation/ justification for pursuing this particular approach/direction, indicating how this approach will enable the objectives of the proposal to be met. In addition to the Technical Concept, this discussion should also include a description of the project objectives, the concept of operation for the new concept to be delivered, maturity of the concept/technology, and the expected operational performance improvements. The Offeror should also include technical risk and proposed mitigations, a life-cycle cost estimate for the concept, applicable concept/system specifications (e.g., weight, dimensions, probability of detection, probability of false alarm, throughput), current TRL of the technology and TRL at the end of the project, with supporting statements regarding the current state of the proposed concept and where it will be after the work is completed.
6. Government Furnished Information and Equipment: A listing and description of government furnished information and equipment that is required for project execution.

7. Relevance to TSA's BAA TTA Objectives and Mission: A description of potential transportation security relevance and contributions of the effort to the agency's specific BAA TTA objective(s). A discussion of how this innovation meets the TSA's mission needs must be included.

8. Operational Utility Assessment Plan: : A plan for demonstrating and evaluating the operational effectiveness of the Offeror's proposed concept in field experiments and/or tests in a simulated environment. This would be a description of how the concept can be proven or tested to demonstrate effectiveness.

9. Expected TSA Support: Identify, describe and include a justification for all tasks that will need the TSA's support to complete (e.g., access to Sensitive Security Information or classified information, Food and Drug Administration [FDA]/ National Institute of Standards and Technology [NIST] safety testing, Transportation Security Lab [TSL]/TSA Systems Integration Facility Source Selection Information [TSIF]/operational testing, etc.). Roles and responsibilities need to clearly be set in this section. The Offeror should include the associated costs in the estimated price. Do not include costs pertaining to Government staff or their support personnel.

10. Management Approach and Teaming Arrangements: A discussion of the overall approach to the management of this effort, including brief discussions of the total organization, use of personnel, project/function/subcontractor/sub-recipient relationships, government research interfaces, and planning, scheduling and control practices. The discussion should identify which personnel and subcontractors/sub-recipients (if any) will be involved, a description of their roles and responsibilities. and include resumes for the Principal Investigator and other key personnel. The Offeror should also include a description of the facilities that are required for the proposed effort.

11. Project Schedule and Milestones: A high level schedule of the programmatic and technical events, and milestones, with a detailed work breakdown structure showing assignments of labor. The following non-exhaustive list are sample items that are typically required under a research effort: delivery of a program management plan, quarterly program management reviews, preliminary design reviews, and critical design reviews.

12. Assertion of Data Rights and/or Rights in Computer Software: Offeror should provide proposed assertions to restrict use, release, or disclosure of data and/or computer software that will be provided in the course of performance of the project. The rules governing these assertions are prescribed in RFO Part 27. The Government may challenge these assertions. If it is determined that data rights are not applicable, indicate no assertions are being made in the proposal submission.

13. Deliverables/Reports: A detailed list of reports and any proposed hardware, software or prototypes, inclusive of the timeframe in which they will be delivered. The following are sample data deliverables that are typically required under a research effort: Technical and Financial Progress Reports, Presentation Materials, and Final Report. An outline of each report shall be delivered for Government comment at least ten (10) business days prior to delivery of each report. Draft reports shall be delivered to the Government five (5) business days prior to formal delivery and review by the Government. The final report shall be due thirty (30) days prior to the end of the period of performance to permit Government review, comments, and resulting Offeror revisions.

Government Evaluation:

TSA will assess the soundness of the Offeror's technical approach to the proposed Technical Task Area (TAA) identified and whether the approach: is reasonable and responsive to the program and task requirements; demonstrates an understanding of the problem; clearly identifies all risks and associated mitigation approaches; and presents a clear plan and schedule to provide a solution to the need presented via the TAAs. The Government reserves the right to evaluate risks identified in an Offeror's Technical Approach to determine if those risks are 'Acceptable' or 'Unacceptable'. TSA will make an assessment of the Offeror's proposed technical approach qualifications, capabilities, and experience to determine if the proposed technical approach has the expertise to perform the proposed work as well as the ability to manage the project cost and complete the project within the proposed schedule in achieving the proposed objectives. Offerors that do not provide sufficient documentation will receive an 'Unacceptable' rating and will not be evaluated further.

Factor 3: Past Performance (Full Proposal)

Proposal Submission Elements – Both Tracks – One submission per TTA:

Proposal Submission Elements:

The Offeror shall submit the following information in Sections 1 and 2 below to facilitate the Government's consideration of Factor 3.

1. Title Page: A title page that identifies the volume and short title of the concept.
2. Past Performance: The Offeror shall provide a summary of not more than five (5) contracts either ongoing or completed during the last three (3) years that demonstrates experience on topics related to the proposed projects. Similar or relevant past experience topics are defined by size, scope, complexity, and contract type. Offerors must either provide the below information or affirmatively state that they possess no relevant, directly related, or similar past performance. The contract summaries shall include the following information:
 - a) Contract number(s) and type
 - b) Name, phone number, and e-mail address of two (2) technical points of contact at the entity for which the contract was performed
 - c) Contracting Officer's name, phone number, and e-mail address
 - d) Contracting Officer's Representative name, phone number, and e-mail address
 - e) Dollar value of the project
 - f) Period of performance
 - g) Detailed description of the work performed
 - h) Explanation of relevancy to the proposed project
 - i) Description of the extent of subcontracting
 - j) Statements relative to performance, i.e., statements describing whether the projects were completed on time, performed satisfactorily while conforming to contract terms and conditions and without degradation in performance or customer satisfaction, and any applicable information on problems encountered during performance. Note: include severity of any quantity, delivery, or cost problems in performing the contract; the corrective action taken; and the effectiveness of the corrective action

Government Evaluation:

The Offerors will be evaluated on performance under existing and prior contracts for similar products or services. Using any past performance information provided in the business volume, the

Government will focus on information that demonstrates quality of performance relative to the size and complexity of the submission.

The Government will evaluate the degree to which the Offeror's past performance references from current or prior customers on contracts (as a prime contractor) demonstrates the ability to perform contracts in a satisfactory manner with the ability to comply with performance schedules, including the completion of tasks, managing work assignments, delivering quality products and services, and what cost/price savings were realized/gained by the Contractor and passed onto the Government.

The Government reserves the right to evaluate performance information from the Government's automated repositories and submitted past performance questionnaires to determine the degree to which the Offeror has demonstrated a record of successful performance for projects of similar size, scope, and complexity to the requirements of this solicitation. If an Offeror lacks a record of relevant past performance the Government will evaluate the Offeror neither favorably nor unfavorably; the Offeror in such cases will receive a 'Neutral' rating. Offerors that have unfavorable past performance will receive an 'Unacceptable' rating and be considered ineligible for award and will not be evaluated further. The Government reserves the right to evaluate risks identified in an Offeror's past performance to determine if 'Acceptable' or 'Unacceptable'.

The automated repositories that may be used by the Government include but are not limited to the Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS) found on the web at <http://www.cpars.csd.disa.mil>, as well as the Past Performance Information Retrieval System (PPIRS).

Factor 4: Price (Full Proposal)

Proposal Submission Elements – Both Tracks – One submission per TTA:

Proposal Submission:

Offerors shall use the price proposal spreadsheet (Attachment 1- Price Evaluation Template.xls) that is attached to this BAA as the template for the price proposal. Offerors should not alter the spreadsheet in a material way but may tailor it to ensure that adequate elements of price are appropriately identified. Offerors are encouraged to use labor rates from existing TSA contracts or GSA schedules. If proposing options, they must be separately priced.

For pricing purposes, assume that performance will start no earlier than five (5) months after submission of the price proposal. Even though considered to be awarded using full and open competition by RFO, it is anticipated that any resultant award will require some level of negotiation by the Government and the Offeror to ensure that all aspects of the proposal reflect a successful approach, including prices. During the negotiation, the Contracting Officer will make a determination as to the need for certified cost and/or pricing data based upon RFO 15.403 prescriptions. Offerors may use commercial market prices to establish reasonableness, in which case Offerors need not provide indirect rates and profit. Salary information is not required in price proposals unless it is the only way Offerors are able to provide justification of labor costs.

1. Title Page: A title page that identifies the volume and short title of the concept.
2. Table of Contents: Optional section that includes a hierarchical listing of sections and subsections of the document indexed by page number.

3. Price Narrative: Explanation of the pricing approach, the estimating approach and methodology, and context for the cost elements delineated in the price proposal spreadsheet(s):

- Part A: Detailed breakdown of all costs by cost category by calendar or Contractor fiscal year:

- a) Direct Labor – Individual labor categories or persons, with associated labor hours and unburdened direct labor rates. Provide escalation rates for out years.
- b) Indirect Costs – Fringe Benefits, Overhead, General and Administrative (G&A), COM, etc. and their applicable allocation bases. If composite rates are used, provide the calculations used in deriving the composite rates.
- c) Travel – The proposed travel cost should include the following for each trip: the purpose of the trip, origin and destination if known, approximate duration, the number of travelers, and the estimated cost per trip must be justified based on the organizations historical average cost per trip or other reasonable basis for estimation. Such estimates and the resultant costs claimed must conform to the applicable Federal cost principals.
- d) Subcontracts/Interorganizational Transfers – A detailed price proposal containing all the elements of the Offeror's price proposal will be required to be submitted by all proposed subcontractors and for all interorganizational transfers. For subcontracts or interorganizational transfers over \$100,000, the subcontract proposal, along with supporting documentation, must be provided via email directly to Contracting Officer at the same time the prime proposal is submitted. The e-mail should identify the proposal title, the prime Offeror, state that the attached proposal is a subcontract, and include a description of the effort to be performed by the subcontractor. The prime contractor should perform and provide a cost/price analysis of each subcontractor's price proposal. Offerors are required to obtain competition to the maximum extent practicable when selecting subcontractors or interorganizational transfers; if the Offeror has obtained competitive quotes, copies should be provided. If the Offeror has selected other than the low bid for inclusion in their proposal or intends to award the subcontract/interorganizational transfer on a sole-source basis, the Offeror should provide rationale for their decision. Certified cost or pricing data may be required for subcontractor proposals over \$950,000. The Offeror is to exclude excessive pass-through charges from subcontractors. The Offeror must identify in its proposal the percentage of effort it intends to perform and the percentage to be performed by each of its proposed subcontractors. If more than 70 percent of the total effort will be performed through subcontractors, the Offeror must include the additional information required by the above-cited clause.
- e) Consultants – Provide a breakdown of the consultant's hours (if any), the hourly rate proposed, any other proposed consultant costs, a copy of the signed Consulting Agreement or other documentation supporting the proposed consultant rate/cost, and a copy of the consultant's proposed statement of work if it is not already separately identified in the prime contractor's proposal.
- f) Materials & Supplies – Provide an itemized list of all proposed materials and supplies for each year including quantities, unit prices, proposed vendors (if known), and the basis for the estimate (e.g., quotes, prior purchases, catalog price lists). If the total cost for materials and supplies exceeds \$100,000 per year, then select a sample of the items proposed and provide catalog price lists/quotes/prior purchase orders to support the price for the items in the sample. All items with a unit price over \$10,000, regardless of the total cost for materials and supplies, must be supported with a copy of catalog price lists/quotes/prior purchase orders.
- g) Contractor Acquired Equipment or Facilities – Equipment and/or facilities are normally furnished by the Contractor. If acquisition of equipment and/or facilities is proposed, a justification for the purchase of the items must be provided including: 1) a very specific description of any equipment/ hardware that it needs to acquire to perform the work, 2) whether or not each particular piece of equipment/hardware will be included as part of a deliverable item under the resulting award, and 3) the basis for the estimate (e.g.,

quotes, prior purchases, catalog price lists). The description should identify the component, nomenclature, and configuration of the equipment/hardware that it proposes to purchase for this effort. The purchase on a direct reimbursement basis of equipment that is not included in a deliverable item will be evaluated and may be allowed on a case-by-case basis. Maximum use of Government integration, test, and experiment facilities is encouraged in each of the Offeror's proposals.

h) Other Direct Costs – Provide an itemized list of all other proposed other direct costs and the basis for the estimate (e.g., quotes, prior purchases, catalog price lists).

i) Fee/Profit (Contract Proposals Only) – Profit or fee is not allowed on direct costs for facilities.

j) Accounting/Purchasing/Estimating Systems – Indicate if you have an approved Purchasing/Estimating System and/or describe the process used to determine the basis of reasonableness (e.g., competition, market research, best value analysis) for subcontractors, consultants, materials, supplies, equipment/facilities, and other direct costs.

- o Part B: Price breakdown by Government fiscal year and task/sub-task corresponding to the same task breakdown in the proposed Statement of Work. When options are contemplated, options must be separately identified and priced by task/subtask.

4. Price Assumptions: Explanation of prices as they relate to the Work Breakdown Structure (WBS), including a table to map hours by labor category against the WBS.

Proposal submissions will be protected from unauthorized disclosure in accordance with RFO 3.104-4 and 15.207 and applicable law/regulations. Offerors are expected to appropriately mark each page of their submission that contains proprietary information.

Government Evaluation:

The Government will use one or more of the analysis techniques set forth in RFO 15.404 to determine that proposed prices are fair and reasonable. In general, a price analysis will be used to verify that the overall price offered is fair and reasonable. However, cost analysis may also be used to evaluate data other than certified cost or pricing data to determine cost reasonableness or cost realism, when a fair and reasonable price cannot be determined through price analysis alone.

The Government will evaluate options for award purposes by adding the total cost for all options to the total cost for the basic requirement. Evaluation of options will not obligate the Government to exercise the options during contract performance.

Other Submission Information: Price (Full Proposal)

Proposal Submission Elements – Both Tracks – One submission per TTA:

Proposal Submission:

1. This acquisition is subject to RFO Subpart 25.1 and 25.4, but only specified countries as listed in HSAR 5200.225.001. To determine whether Offerors are compliant with the Buy American Act and applicable Trade Agreements, Offerors shall provide 1) a confirmation of the country in which the prototypes are manufactured (if applicable), and 2) the origin and cost of each individual components that make up the system (if applicable), and 3) the cost of each individual components that make up the system (if applicable). In addition, the Offerors shall complete the Buy American Certificate.

2. In an Appendix, the Offeror shall provide any other information relevant to the proposal. Included in this section should be a list of any current or pending awards or proposals with DHS or other Government agencies that directly pertain to work proposed in this BAA. Other funding summary list shall contain the

funding organization, contracting officer, contract number, role (prime or sub), Period of Performance, deliverables, current status, Award Amount, Name of Project Manager or Project Engineer. Offerors shall not duplicate efforts or costs under this contract. A clear description of delineation between the funded work and the proposed work must be provided in terms of scope and deliverables. This section will not count towards the proposal page count limit.

3. Subcontracting Plans- Contract proposals that exceed \$900,000 and submitted by other than small businesses will submit a Small Business Subcontracting Plan in accordance with RFO 52.219-9.

4. Representations and Certifications- For contract proposals, in accordance with RFO 4.203, Offerors shall complete and submit electronic annual representations and certifications at <http://orca.bpn.gov>.

5. Offeror Responsibility- Offerors must submit as part of their full proposal, a completed certification as required by RFO 52.209-5. Additionally, Offerors must meet minimum standards related to responsibility as described by RFO 9.104.

Government Evaluation:

- a. The Government will confirm whether Offerors' systems are compliant with Buy American Act (RFO clause 52.225-1) or Trade Agreement (RFO clause 52.225-5) requirements and will follow RFO 25.402 and 25.5, if applicable.
- b. The Government will assess the Offerors' other relevant information to determine if there are any risks to the Government. Assessing the risks of each offer is part of TSA's overall evaluation plan; not a stand-alone, identified evaluation criterion.
- c. If applicable, the Government will confirm whether a submitted Small Business Subcontracting Plan meets the elements of RFO 52.219-9.
- d. The Government will confirm the required representation and certifications as required in RFO 4.203 are provided in addition to a completed certification as required by RFO 52.209-5. The Government will confirm the Offeror meets the minimum standards related to responsibility as described by RFO 9.104.

Factor 1- Entrance Criteria: The Offeror shall present the following information in Sections A and B below to facilitate the Government's consideration of Factor 1 for all submissions.

- A. Page Limits – The concept paper shall be a single document limited to 15 pages as follows:

Section	Subsections	Page Limit
1	Cover Letter	1 page
2	Table of Contents	1 page – Optional
3	Technical Concept	7 pages
4	Relevance to the TSA's BAA TTA objective(s) and Mission + Operational Utility Assessment Plan (see description below)	6 pages

5	List of Tasks + List of Deliverables + Expected TSA Support + Key Dates/Milestones + Capabilities/Related Experience + Estimated Costs+ Intellectual Property (IP)/Data Rights	(combined for sections 4-6)
6	Capabilities/Related Experience	

B. Content Requirements:

1. **Offers Shall Include a Cover Letter:** The Cover letter shall be labeled “CONCEPT PAPER” and shall include the BAA number “70T04026BAA7573N001, TTA #, proposed title, points of contact, address, telephone number, e- mail address, corporate Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) number, Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) Code, Taxpayer Identification Number (ID) number, certifications required at RFO 52.209-5, and the period of performance of the project in months. The Cover letter must also include the name and contact information for the individual authorized to negotiate and contractually obligate on behalf of the Offeror. Inclusion of a table of contents and/or proposal checklists that index proposal features as compared with BAA objectives are optional.
2. **Technical Concept:** A description of the innovation, maturity of the concept/technology, technical risk areas, and proposed mitigation. The description should include the project objectives, the concept of operation for the new concepts to be delivered, and the expected operational performance improvements. The description should also include an estimation of the applicable system specifications (e.g., weight, dimensions, probability of detection, probability of false alarm, throughput), limitations of selected technology, a declaration of the current Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of the technology and also of the projected TRL of the technology at the end of the proposed period of performance, with a brief supporting statement for each regarding the current state of the proposed concept and where it will be after the work is completed.
3. **Relevance to TSA’s BAA TTA Objective(s) and Mission:** A description of potential transportation security relevance and contributions of the effort to the agency’s specific BAA TTA objective(s). A discussion of how this innovation meets the TSA’s mission needs must be included.
4. **Operational Utility Assessment Plan:** A plan for demonstrating and evaluating the operational effectiveness of the Offeror’s proposed products or processes in field experiments and/or tests in a simulated environment. This would be a description of how the solution can be proven or tested to demonstrate effectiveness.
5. **List of Tasks:** A description of specific tasks that would need to be accomplished in order to deliver the proposed capability.

6. **List of Deliverables:** A list of items that will become TSA property (e.g., prototypes, reports, test objects, consumables, etc.).
7. **Expected TSA Support:** A list of all tasks proposed in the contract that will need the TSA's support to complete (e.g., Access to Sensitive Security Information or Classified Information, Food and Drug Administration [FDA]/ National Institute of Standards and Technology [NIST] safety testing, TSL/TSA Systems Integration Facility [TSIF]/Operational testing, etc.). The Offeror needs to list these tasks, identify the type of support needed with a justification, and include the associated costs in the estimated cost.
8. **Key Dates/Milestones:** A list of key dates from contract award through task completion.
9. **Estimated Cost:** A description of the funding required to perform the tasks being proposed and to further develop and explore the proposed concept(s).
10. **Capabilities/Related Experience:** A brief description of similar work performed or qualifications related to the proposed solution.
11. **Intellectual Property (IP)/Data Rights:** A summary of the intellectual property and data rights asserted.

C.3.1 Content and Format of Full Proposals – Both Tracks

Offerors who submit the required concept paper elements defined in C.3.1 above and are found "Acceptable" for Factor 1, will be invited via email to provide a full proposal addressing the elements set forth below.

* Please note that the cover letter, technical proposal, subcontracting plan, detailed past experience information, and full price proposal will not be required if the concept paper is not selected to move to the award phase. TSA may make changes to the content of the proposed concept in the final SOW issued by the TSA, to reflect the complete requirements associated with the proposed concept. TSA reserves the right to partially fund a concept or incorporate option periods.

The anticipated format when submitting a full proposal is as follows:

A. Page Limits – Each volume of a full proposal shall be a separate document.

I. Cover Volume

Section	Page Limit
1. Cover Letter	1 page

2. Proposal Checklist	No page limit – Optional
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The Cover Page must include the words “Business Volume” and the following:

- 1) BAA number
- 2) Title of volume
- 3) Identity of prime Offeror and complete list of subcontractors, if applicable
- 4) Technical contact (name, address, phone/fax, electronic mail address)
- 5) Administrative/business contact (name, address, phone/fax, electronic email address, DUNS, NAICS)

II. Technical Proposal Volume

Section	Page Limit
1. Title Page	1 page
2. Table(s) of Contents	No page limit – Optional
3. Table of Acronyms	No page limit – Optional
4. Statement of Work (derived from the Concept Paper)	No page limit
5. Technical Approach and Justification	15 pages
6. Government Furnished Information and Equipment	2 pages
7. Relevance to TSA’s BAA TTA objective(s) and mission	2 pages
8. Operational Utility Assessment Plan	5 pages
9. List of TSA Support	1 page
10. Project Schedule and Milestones	No page limit
11. Assertion of Data Rights and/or Rights in Computer Software (if any)	No page limit
12. Deliverables / Reports	No page limit
13. Management Approach	5 pages
14. Resumes	No page limit

III. Past Performance Volume

Section	Page Limit
1. Title Page	1 page
2. Subcontracting Plan	No page limit

3. Past Experience	No page limit
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IV. Cost Proposal Volume

Section	Page Limit
1. Title Page	1 page
2. Table of Contents	No page limit – Optional
3. Cost Narrative	No page limit
4. Price Assumptions	No page limit
5. Cost Proposal Spreadsheet(s)	No page limit

B. Technical Proposal Volume Content:

Factor 2 - Technical Approach: The Offeror shall provide the following information in Sections 1 - 14 below to facilitate the Government's consideration of Factor 2.

1. **Title Page:** A title page that identifies the volume and short title of the concept.
2. **Table(s) of Contents:** Optional section that includes one or more of the following: a hierarchical listing of sections and subsections of the document indexed by page number; a listing of the figures indexed by page numbers; and a listing of tables indexed by page numbers.
3. **Table of Acronyms:** Optional section that includes a table of acronyms that associates technical abbreviations with their unabbreviated forms.
4. **Statement of Work:** A SOW clearly detailing the scope and objectives of the effort and the technical approach derived from the concept paper. It is anticipated that the proposed SOW, with agreed upon revisions, will be incorporated as an attachment to the resultant award instrument. To this end, the proposals must be consistent with RFO Part 35 and include a severable, self-standing SOW, without any proprietary restrictions, which can be attached to the contract or agreement award. Include a detailed listing of the technical tasks/subtasks organized by year. Submission of the SOW without restrictive markings is the Offeror's affirmation that the SOW is non-proprietary and releasable in response to Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) requests.
5. **Technical Approach and Justification:** The major portion of the proposal should consist of a clear description of the technical approach being proposed. This discussion should provide the technical foundation/justification for pursuing this particular approach/direction and why one could expect it to enable the

objectives of the proposal to be met. This discussion should also include a description of the project objectives, the concept of operation for the new capabilities to be delivered, maturity of the concept/technology, and the expected operational performance

improvements. The Offeror should also include technical risk and proposed mitigations, a life-cycle cost estimate for the system, applicable system specifications (e.g., weight, dimensions, probability of detection, probability of false alarm, throughput), current TRL of the technology and TRL at the end of the project, with supporting statements regarding the current state of the proposed concept and where it will be after the work is completed.

6. **Government Furnished Information and Equipment:** A listing and description of government furnished information and equipment that is required for project execution.
7. **Relevance to TSA's BAA TTA Objectives and Mission:** A description of potential transportation security relevance and contributions of the effort to the agency's specific mission and BAA TTA objective(s). A discussion of why this innovation meets TSA's mission needs must be included.
8. **Operational Utility Assessment Plan:** A plan for demonstrating and evaluating the operational effectiveness of the Offeror's proposed products or processes in field experiments and/or tests in a simulated environment.
9. **List of TSA Support:** Identify and describe all tasks proposed in the contract that will need TSA's support to complete (e.g., Access to Sensitive Security Information or Classified Information, FDA/NIST safety testing, TSL/TSIF/Operational testing, etc.). Roles and responsibilities need to clearly be set in this section. The Offeror needs to list these tasks and include the associated costs in the estimated cost. Do not include costs pertaining to Government staff or their support personnel.
10. **Management Approach and Teaming Arrangements:** A description of roles and responsibilities.
11. **Project Schedule and Milestones:** A high level schedule of the programmatic and technical events, and milestones with a detailed work breakdown structure showing assignments of labor. The following non-exhaustive list are sample items that are typically required under a research effort: programmatic milestones, delivery of a program management plan, quarterly program management reviews, preliminary design reviews, and critical design reviews.
12. **Assertion of Data Rights and/or Rights in Computer Software:** For a contract award, an Offeror may provide with its proposal assertions to restrict use, release, or disclosure of data and/or computer software that will be provided in the course of performance of the project. The rules governing these assertions are prescribed

in RFO Part 27. The Government may challenge assertions that are provided in improper format or that do not properly acknowledge earlier federal funding of related research by the Offeror. If it is determined that data rights are not applicable, indicate no assertions are being made in the proposal submission.

13. **Deliverables/Reports:** A detailed list of reports and any proposed hardware, software or prototypes, inclusive of the timeframe in which they will be delivered.

The following are sample data deliverables that are typically required under a research effort: Technical and Financial Progress Reports, Presentation Materials, and Final Report. An outline of each report shall be delivered for Government comment at least ten (10) business days prior to delivery of each report. Draft reports shall be delivered to the Government five business days prior to formal delivery and review by the Government. The final report shall be due 30 days prior to the end of the period of performance to permit Government review, comments, and resulting Offeror revisions.

14. **Management Approach:** A discussion of the overall approach to the management of this effort, including brief discussions of the total organization, use of personnel, project/function/subcontractor/sub-recipient relationships, government research interfaces, and planning, scheduling and control practices. The discussion should identify which personnel and subcontractors/sub-recipients (if any) will be involved and include resumes for the Principal Investigator and other key personnel. The Offeror should include a description of the facilities that are required for the proposed effort with a description of any Government Furnished Equipment (e.g., hardware, software, information) required.

C. Factor 3- Past Performance Volume Content:

Factor 3- Past Performance: The Offeror shall submit the following information in Sections 1 and 2 below to facilitate the Government's consideration of Factor 3.

1. **Title Page:** A title page that identifies the volume and short title of the concept.
2. **Past Performance:** The Offeror shall provide a summary of not more than five (5) contracts either ongoing or completed during the last three (3) years that demonstrates experience on topics related to the proposed projects. Similar or relevant past experience topics are defined by size, scope, complexity, and contract type. Offerors must either provide the below information or affirmatively state that they possess no relevant, directly related, or similar past performance. The contract summaries shall include the following information:
 - a) Contract number(s) and type
 - b) Name, phone number, and e-mail address of two (2) technical points of contact at the entity for which the contract was performed
 - c) Contracting Officer's name, phone number, and e-mail address

- d) Contracting Officer's Representative name, phone number, and e-mail address
- e) Dollar value of the project
- f) Period of performance
- g) Detailed description of the work performed
- h) Explanation of relevancy to the proposed project
- i) Description of the extent of subcontracting
- j) Statements relative to performance, i.e., statements describing whether the projects were completed on time, performed satisfactorily while conforming to contract terms and conditions and without degradation in performance or customer satisfaction, and any applicable information on problems encountered during performance. Note: include severity of any quantity, delivery, or cost problems in performing the contract; the corrective action taken; and the effectiveness of the corrective action

D. Factor 4- Price and Cost Volume Content

The following information is provided to assist Offerors in preparing and submitting an adequate and compliant price proposal. The purpose of the submission of cost or pricing data is to enable Government personnel to perform price analysis and ultimately negotiate a fair and reasonable price. Offerors are reminded that the responsibility for providing adequate supporting data and attachments lies solely with the Offeror. Further, the Offeror must also bear the burden of proof in establishing reasonableness of proposed costs; therefore, it is in the Offeror's best interest to submit a fully supportable and well-prepared price proposal. The basis and rationale for all proposed price elements should be provided as part of the proposal so that Government personnel can place reliance on the information as current, complete, and accurate.

Offerors shall use the price proposal spreadsheet (Attachment 1- Price Evaluation Template.xls) that is attached to this BAA as the template for the price proposal. Offerors should not alter the spreadsheet in a material way but may tailor it to ensure that adequate elements of price are appropriately identified. Offerors are encouraged to use labor rates from existing TSA contracts or GSA schedules.

If proposing options, they must be separately priced.

For pricing purposes, assume that performance will start no earlier than five (5) months after submission of the cost proposal.

Even though considered to be awarded using full and open competition by the RFO, it is anticipated that any resultant award will require some level of negotiation by the Government and the Offeror to ensure that all aspects of the proposal reflect a successful approach, including costs/prices. During the negotiation, the Contracting Officer will make a determination as to the need for certified cost and or pricing data based upon RFO 15.403 prescriptions. Offerors may use commercial market prices to establish reasonableness, in which case Offerors need not provide indirect rates and

profit.

Salary information is not required in price proposals unless it is the only way Offerors are able to provide justification of labor costs.

1. **Title Page:** A title page that identifies the volume and short title of the concept.
2. **Table of Contents:** Optional section that includes a hierarchical listing of sections and subsections of the document indexed by page number.
3. **Price Narrative:** Explanation of the pricing approach, the estimating approach and methodology, and context for the cost elements delineated in the cost proposal spreadsheet(s):
 - **Part A: Detailed breakdown of all costs by cost category by calendar or Contractor fiscal year:**
 - a) Direct Labor – Individual labor categories or persons, with associated labor hours and unburdened direct labor rates. Provide escalation rates for out years.
 - b) Indirect Costs – Fringe Benefits, Overhead, General and Administrative (G&A), COM, etc. and their applicable allocation bases. If composite rates are used, provide the calculations used in deriving the composite rates.
 - c) Travel – The proposed travel cost should include the following for each trip: the purpose of the trip, origin and destination if known, approximate duration, the number of travelers, and the estimated cost per trip must be justified based on the organizations historical average cost per trip or other reasonable basis for estimation. Such estimates and the resultant costs claimed must conform to the applicable Federal cost principals.
 - d) Subcontracts/Interorganizational Transfers – A detailed price proposal containing all the elements of the Offeror's price proposal will be required to be submitted by all proposed subcontractors and for all interorganizational transfers. For subcontracts or interorganizational transfers over **\$100,000**, the subcontract proposal, along with supporting documentation, must be provided via email directly to Contracting Officer at the same time the prime proposal is submitted. The e-mail should identify the proposal title, the prime Offeror, state that the attached proposal is a subcontract, and include a description of the effort to be performed by the subcontractor. The prime Offeror should perform and provide a cost/price analysis of each subcontractor's price proposal. Offerors are required to obtain competition to the maximum extent practicable when selecting subcontractors or interorganizational transfers; if the Offeror has obtained competitive quotes, copies should be provided. If the Offeror has selected

other than the low bid for inclusion in their proposal or intends to award the subcontract/ interorganizational transfer on a sole-source basis, the Offeror should provide rationale for their decision. Certified cost or pricing data may be required for subcontractor proposals over **\$900,000**. The Offeror is to exclude excessive pass-through charges from subcontractors. The Offeror must identify in its proposal the percentage of effort it intends to perform and the percentage to be performed by each of its proposed subcontractors. If more than 70 percent of the total effort will be performed through subcontractors, the Offeror must include the additional information required by the above-cited clause.

- e) Consultants – Provide a breakdown of the consultant’s hours (if any), the hourly rate proposed, any other proposed consultant costs, a copy of the signed Consulting Agreement or other documentation supporting the proposed consultant rate/cost, and a copy of the consultant’s proposed statement of work if it is not already separately identified in the prime contractor’s proposal.
- f) Materials & Supplies – Provide an itemized list of all proposed materials and supplies for each year including quantities, unit prices, proposed vendors (if known), and the basis for the estimate (e.g., quotes, prior purchases, catalog price lists). If the total cost for materials and supplies exceeds \$100,000 per year, then select a sample of the items proposed and provide catalog price lists/quotes/prior purchase orders to support the price for the items in the sample. All items with a unit price over \$10,000, regardless of the total cost for materials and supplies, must be supported with a copy of catalog price lists/quotes/prior purchase orders.
- g) Offeror-Acquired Equipment or Facilities – Equipment and/or facilities are normally furnished by the Offeror. If acquisition of equipment and/or facilities is proposed, a justification for the purchase of the items must be provided including: 1) a very specific description of any equipment/hardware that it needs to acquire to perform the work, 2) whether or not each particular piece of equipment/hardware will be included as part of a deliverable item under the resulting award, and 3) the basis for the estimate (e.g., quotes, prior purchases, catalog price lists). The description should identify the component, nomenclature, and configuration of the equipment/hardware that it proposes to purchase for this effort. The purchase on a direct reimbursement basis of equipment that is not included in a deliverable item will be evaluated and may be allowed on a case-by-case basis. Maximum use of Government integration, test, and experiment facilities is encouraged in each of the Offeror’s proposals.
- h) Other Direct Costs – Provide an itemized list of all proposed other direct costs and the basis for the estimate (e.g., quotes, prior purchases, catalog price lists).

- i) Fee/Profit (Contract Proposals Only) – Profit or fee is not allowed on direct costs for facilities.
 - j) Accounting/Purchasing/Estimating Systems – Indicate if you have an approved Purchasing/Estimating System and/or describe the process used to determine the basis of reasonableness (e.g., competition, market research, best value analysis) for subcontractors, consultants, materials, supplies, equipment/facilities, and other direct costs.
- **Part B:** Price breakdown by Government fiscal year and task/sub-task corresponding to the same task breakdown in the proposed Statement of Work. When options are contemplated, options must be separately identified and priced by task/subtask.
4. **Price Assumptions:** Explanation of prices as they relate to the Work Breakdown Structure (WBS), including a table to map hours by labor category against the WBS.

Proposal submissions will be protected from unauthorized disclosure in accordance with RFO 3.104-4 and 15.207 and applicable law/regulations. Offerors are expected to appropriately mark each page of their submission that contains proprietary information.

E. Other Submission Information:

1. This acquisition is subject to RFO Subpart 25.1 and 25.4, but only specified countries as listed in HSAR 5200.225.001. To determine whether Offerors are compliant with the Buy American Act and applicable Trade Agreements, Offerors shall provide 1) a confirmation of the country in which the prototypes are manufactured (if applicable), 2) the origin and cost of each individual component that make up the system (if applicable), and 3) the cost of each individual component that make up the system (if applicable). In addition, the Offerors shall complete the Buy American Certificate.
2. In an Appendix, the Offeror shall provide any other information relevant to the proposal. Included in this section should be a list of any current or pending awards or proposals with DHS or other Government agencies that directly pertain to work proposed in this BAA. Other funding summary list shall contain the funding organization, contracting officer, contract number, role (prime or sub), Period of Performance, deliverables, current status, Award Amount, and the Name of the Project Manager or Project Engineer. Offerors shall not duplicate efforts or costs under this contract. A clear description of delineation between the funded work and the proposed work must be provided in terms of scope and deliverables. This section will not count towards the proposal page count limit.

3. Subcontracting Plans- Contract proposals that exceed \$900,000 and submitted by other than small businesses will submit a Small Business Subcontracting Plan in accordance with RFO 52.219-9.
4. Representations and Certifications- For contract proposals, in accordance with RFO 4.203-1(b), Offerors shall have "...an active Federal Government contracts registration in SAM when they submit an offer or quotation, and at the time of award...".
5. Offeror Responsibility- Offerors must submit, as part of their full proposal, a completed certification as required by RFO 52.209-5. Additionally, Offerors must meet minimum standards related to responsibility as described by RFO 9.104.

Section D: Evaluation Information

D.1 Evaluation

Evaluation will be conducted per RFO 35.102 for competitive selection of responses to a broad agency announcement for proposals that meet the Government's requirements stated above. The formal source selection procedures outlined in RFO Part 15 do not apply to this solicitation. In addition, the TSA reserves the right to award zero, one, or multiple awards without communications but reserves the right to conduct communications as needed. If needed, communications may be written or oral, with specific Offerors only, and as circumstances warrant. TSA also reserves the right to request full proposals with specific Offerors only as circumstances warrant.

The Government intends to award to none, one, or multiple Offeror(s) whose offer, conforming to this BAA represents an approach that is beneficial to the Government. Award decisions will be based on a competitive selection of submissions resulting from a scientific and cost review.

Concept papers selected for further consideration will require Offerors to submit a full proposal for evaluation. While competitive, submissions will not be evaluated against each other since they will not be submitted against a common SOW. Offerors who submit concept papers that have no direct application to the objectives in this BAA will be rejected. Proposals will not be evaluated if the Offeror's concept paper is declined.

The Government will evaluate submissions and assign adjectival ratings to all non-price evaluation factors identified below. TSA will assign adjectival ratings at the factor level. There are no identified sub-factors. Headings and subheadings are for organizational purposes only. The Government will not assign an adjectival rating(s) to 'Other Submission Information' provided in the proposal; however, any Offeror that has not provided the required information may be considered non-compliant and will be ineligible for award. Any Offeror receiving an adjectival

rating of 'Unacceptable' for any non-price factor will be considered ineligible for award and the Government will not evaluate the remaining factors.

All submissions will be evaluated by BAA technical evaluators using the evaluation criteria detailed in this BAA. The technical evaluators will review concept papers and select promising concepts to be presented to the RCA CMs. The technical evaluators are comprised of various subject matter experts and program officials with the appropriate technical and functional expertise necessary to provide a complete and balanced evaluation of Offeror submissions.

Factors

TSA will review submissions based on the following criteria in descending order of importance:

1. Factor 1: Entrance Criteria (Concept Paper) Track 01

TSA will review the Offerors concept paper to determine the overall scientific and technical merits and TRL level, maturity of the concept/technology, evidence of the stated TRL level of 5 or higher; the potential importance, relevance, and timeliness of the effort to the BAA TTA objective(s) and TSA/RCA mission; the Offeror's capabilities, the concept of operation for the new capabilities to be delivered, related experience, facilities, management capabilities (including key personnel), program plan (e.g., key milestones, list of tasks, and deliverables), techniques or unique combinations of these which are integral factors for achieving the proposal objectives; proposed costs; and availability of funds. In addition, TSA will assess the potential transportation security relevance and value added to the TSA's specific mission and the expected operational performance improvements, and the feasibility of achieving expected improvements considering project resources. Offerors that do not provide sufficient documentation will receive an 'Unacceptable' rating and be considered ineligible for the next phase and will not be evaluated further. The Government reserves the right to evaluate risks identified in an Offeror's concept paper to determine if 'Acceptable' or 'Unacceptable'.

1. Factor 1: Entrance Criteria (Concept Paper) Track 02

TSA will review the Offeror's concept paper to determine the overall scientific and technical merits and TRL level, maturity of the concept/technology, evidence of the stated TRL Level of 6 or higher for Track 02; the potential importance, relevance, and timeliness of the effort to the BAA TTA objective(s) and TSA/RCA mission; the Offeror's capabilities, the concept of operation for the new capabilities to be delivered, related experience, facilities, management capabilities (including key personnel), program plan (e.g., key milestones, list of tasks, and deliverables), techniques or unique combinations of these which are integral factors for achieving the proposal objectives; proposed costs; and availability of funds. In addition, TSA will assess the potential transportation security relevance and value added to the TSA's specific mission and the expected operational performance improvements, and the feasibility of achieving expected improvements considering project resources. Offerors that do not provide sufficient documentation will receive an 'Unacceptable' rating and will not be evaluated further. The Government reserves the right to evaluate risks identified in an Offeror's concept paper to determine if 'Acceptable' or 'Unacceptable'.

2. Factor 2: Technical Approach (Full Proposal) Both Tracks

TSA will assess the soundness of the Offeror's technical approach to the proposed Technical Task Area identified and whether the approach is reasonable and responsive to the program and task requirements; demonstrates an understanding of the problem; clearly identifies all risks and associated mitigation approaches; and presents a clear plan and schedule to provide a solution to the need presented in this window. TSA will make an assessment of the Offeror's qualifications, capabilities, and experience to determine if the proposed team has the expertise to perform the proposed work as well as the ability to manage the project cost and complete the project within the proposed schedule in achieving the proposed objectives. Offerors that do not provide sufficient documentation will receive an 'Unacceptable' rating and be considered ineligible for the next phase and will not be evaluated further. The Government reserves the right to evaluate risks identified in an Offeror's Technical Approach to determine if those risks are 'Acceptable' or 'Unacceptable'.

3. Factor 3: Past Performance (Full Proposal) Both Tracks

The Offerors will be evaluated on performance under existing and prior contracts for similar products or services. Using any past performance information provided in the business volume, the Government will focus on information that demonstrates quality of performance relative to the size and complexity of the submission.

The Government will evaluate the degree to which the Offeror's past performance references from current or prior customers on contracts (as a prime contractor) demonstrates the ability to perform contracts in a satisfactory manner with the ability to comply with performance schedules, including the completion of tasks, managing work assignments, delivering quality products and services, and what cost/price savings were realized/gained by the Offeror and passed onto the Government.

The Government reserves the right to evaluate performance information from the Government's automated repositories and submitted past performance questionnaires to determine the degree to which the Offeror has demonstrated a record of successful performance for projects of similar size, scope, and complexity to the requirements of this solicitation. If an Offeror lacks a record of relevant past performance the Government will evaluate the Offeror neither favorably nor unfavorably and will receive a 'Neutral' rating. Offerors that have unfavorable past performance will receive an 'Unacceptable' rating and be considered ineligible for award and will not be evaluated further. The Government reserves the right to evaluate risks identified in an Offeror's past performance to determine if 'Acceptable' or 'Unacceptable'.

The automated repositories that may be used by the Government include but are not limited to the Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS) found on the web at <http://www.cpars.csd.disa.mil> as well as the Past Performance Information Retrieval System (PPIRS).

4. Factor 4- Price (Full Proposal) Both Tracks

The Government will use one or more of the analysis techniques set forth in RFO 15.404 to determine that proposed prices are fair and reasonable. In general, a price analysis will be

used to verify that the overall price offered is fair and reasonable. However, cost analysis may also be used to evaluate data other than certified cost or pricing data to determine cost reasonableness or cost realism, when a fair and reasonable price cannot be determined through price analysis alone.

The Government will evaluate options for award purposes by adding the total cost for all options to the total cost for the basic requirement. Evaluation of options will not obligate the Government to exercise the options during contract performance.

5. Other Submission Information

- a. The Government will confirm whether Offerors' systems are compliant with Buy American Act (RFO clause 52.225-1) or Trade Agreement (RFO clause 52.225-5) requirements and will follow RFO 25.402 and 25.5, if applicable.
- b. The Government will assess the Offerors' other relevant information to determine if there are any risks to the Government. Assessing the risks of each offer is part of TSA's overall evaluation plan; not a stand-alone, identified evaluation criterion.
- c. If applicable, the Government will confirm whether a submitted Small Business Subcontracting Plan meets the elements of RFO 52.219-9.
- d. The Government will confirm the required representation and certifications as required in RFO 4.203 are provided in addition to a completed certification as required by RFO 52.209-5. The Government will confirm the Offeror meets the minimum standards related to responsibility as described by RFO 9.104.

Overall, the technical factors (1 – 3 above) are in descending order of importance and combined are more important than the price and cost factor (4). Requirements will also be evaluated against TSA's available funds. The degree of importance of price will increase with the degree of equality of the proposals in relation to the other factors on which selection is to be based, or when the cost is so significantly high as to diminish the value of the proposal's technical superiority to the Government.

D.2. Evaluation Panel

Concept papers and full proposals submitted under this BAA will be protected from unauthorized disclosure in accordance with RFO 3.104-4 and 15.207. The technical evaluators will perform the evaluation of technical proposals. Proposal selection and award decisions are solely the responsibility of Government personnel.

Section E: Other Requirements

E.1. North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) Code

The NAICS code for this announcement is "541715" Research and Development in the Physical,

Engineering, and Life Sciences (except Nanotechnology and Biotechnology) with a small business size standard of 1,000 employees.”

E.2. System for Award Management (SAM)

Successful Offerors not already registered in the SAM will be required to register in SAM prior to award of any contract.

E.3 Clauses

Any resultant contract will be subject to the Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) and/or the Revolutionary FAR Overhaul (RFO) clauses and will contain all RFO FAR and/or FAR-required clauses and TSA-specific clauses for the type of contract to be awarded. TSA will provide the required RFO FAR and/or FAR clauses and applicable TSA clauses during negotiations of the full proposal submission. Anticipated TSA ITAR clauses are provided in Attachment 2.

E.4 Data Rights

Data rights to be obtained by the Government shall be negotiated under an awarded procurement instrument, and the applicable RFO FAR and/or FAR clauses will be included in the award.

E.5. Information Technology Acquisition Review

All procurements require an Information Technology Acquisition Review (ITAR) by the TSA Chief Information Officer (CIO) as stipulated in the Federal Information Technology Acquisition Reform Act (FITARA) signed into Law, December 19, 2014.

To satisfy TSA IT requirements, the Offeror may be required to include additional contract clauses as well as completing additional forms and documents to proceed with official contract negotiations and/or award. Sample ITAR terms are provided in Attachment 2.

Section F: Other Information

F.1. Government Property/Government Furnished Equipment (GFE) and Facilities

TSA facilities and operational resources may be available and should be considered as potential government-furnished equipment/facilities. These facilities and resources are of high value and some are in constant demand by multiple programs. It is unlikely that all facilities would be used for any one specific program. The use of these facilities and resources must be negotiated prior to award. Offerors should explain as part of their proposals which of these facilities are critical resources for the project success. Offerors should be aware that all access to TSA provided information or facilities will require background checks and/or suitability determinations prior to beginning the project. In some cases, depending upon the type of investigation, these checks

may take six (6) to eight (8) weeks to complete.

F.2. Security Classification

In order to facilitate intra-program collaboration and technology transfer, the Government will attempt to enable technology developers to work at the unclassified level to the maximum extent possible. If required and approved, Sensitive Security Information (SSI) will be provided to Offerors following a contract award using established TSA policies and procedures for disclosure. Release of SSI prior to contract award is highly unlikely. Offerors are encouraged to identify the need for specific SSI in proposals.

F.3. Organizational Conflicts of Interest

All Offerors and proposed subcontractors must affirm whether they are providing scientific, engineering, and technical assistance (SETA) or similar support to any TSA or DHS technical office(s) through an active contract or subcontract. All affirmations must state which office(s) the Offeror supports and identify the prime contract numbers. Affirmations shall be furnished at the time of proposal submission. All facts relevant to the existence or potential existence of organizational conflicts of interest (RFO 9.5) must be disclosed. The disclosure shall include a description of the action the Offeror has taken or proposes to take to avoid, neutralize, or mitigate such conflict. In accordance with RFO 9.503 and without prior approval, an Offeror cannot simultaneously be a SETA and a research and development performer. Proposals that fail to fully disclose potential conflicts of interests or do not have acceptable plans to mitigate identified conflicts will be rejected without technical evaluation and withdrawn from further consideration for award. If a prospective Offeror believes that any conflict of interest exists or may exist (whether organizational or otherwise), the Offeror should promptly raise the issue with TSA by sending his/her contact information and a summary of the potential conflict by e-mail to OPSinfo@tsa.dhs.gov and cc: Siobhan.Mullen@tsa.dhs.gov and Matthew.Coniglio@tsa.dhs.gov before time and effort are expended in preparing a proposal and mitigation plan. If, in the sole opinion of the Government after full consideration of the circumstances, any conflict situation cannot be effectively avoided or mitigated, the proposal may be rejected without technical evaluation and withdrawn from further consideration for award under this BAA.

F.4. Project Meetings and Reviews

Individual program reviews between the TSA and the performer will be held as necessary. Program status reviews may also be held to provide a forum for reviews of the latest results from experiments and any other incremental progress towards the major demonstrations. These meetings will be held at various sites throughout the country as determined by the TSA and the Offeror. Offerors are advised to identify and propose all costs related to site visits, demonstrations, and program meetings.

F.5. Press Releases

Once a project is submitted to the TSA, Offerors are prohibited from making public comments

regarding their proposal without the expressed written approval of the Contracting Officer.

F.6. Invoicing and Payments

Each resultant award will contain specific details concerning invoicing and payments.

Section G: Attachments and Appendices

Attachment 1 - Price Evaluation Template

Attachment 2- TSA and ITAR Clauses

Attachment 3 - TSA's Configuration Management Plan for OAPM

Appendix 1 - Technology Readiness Level Definitions

Section H: List of Acronyms

Acronym/Abbreviation	Definition
BOM	Bill of Materials
CAGE	Commercial and Government Entity
CBRN	Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear
CDR	Critical Design Review
CD-ROM	Compact Disk-Read Only Memory
CFR	Code of Federal Regulations
CI	Configuration Items
CM	Capability Manager
CO	Contracting Officer
COR	Contracting Officer's Representative
CSAR	Configuration Status Accounting Report
DEP	Deviated Engineering Proposal
DHS	Department of Homeland Security
DUNS	Data Universal Numbering System
DVD	Digital Video Disc
ECP	Engineering Change Proposal
EM	Electromagnetic
FAR	Federal Acquisition Regulation
FCA	Functional Configuration Audit
FDA	Food and Drug Administration
FDRS	Field Data Reporting System
FFP	Firm Fixed-Price
FOIA	Freedom of Information Act
G&A	General and Administrative
GUI	Graphical User Interface
HLS EA	Homeland Security Enterprise Architecture

Acronym/Abbreviation	Definition
IA	Information Assurance
ID	Identification Number
iSAT	integrated Site Acceptance Testing
IT	Information Technology
LRU	Lowest Replaceable Unit
MCIL	Master Configuration Item List
MD	Management Directive
MMW	Millimeter Wave
NIST	National Institute of Standards and Technology
NSP	Not Separately Priced
OEM	Original Equipment Manufacturer
OMB	Office of Management and Budget
OPS	On-Person Screening
OSC	Office of Security Capabilities
PAC	Post Award Conference
PCA	Physical Configuration Audit
PDR	Preliminary Design Review
PL	Public Law
PMR	Project Management Review
POC	Point of Contact
PoP	Period of Performance
RCA	Requirements and Capability Analysis
RFC	Requests for Change
RFI	Request for Information
RFO	Revolutionary FAR Overhaul
RFP	Request for Proposal
SAM	System for Award Management
SCR	System Concept Review
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
SOW	Statement of Work
SSI	Sensitive Security Information
T&E	Test and Evaluation
BAA	Broad Agency Announcement
TIM	Technical Interchange Meeting
TRL	Technology Readiness Level
TRN	Test Readiness Notification
TRR	Test Readiness Review
TSA	Transportation Security Administration
TSE	Transportation Security Equipment
TSIF	TSA Systems Integration Facility
TSL	Transportation Security Laboratory
TSO	Transportation Security Officer
TTA	Technical Task Areas
VRTM	Verification Requirements Traceability Matrix
WBS	Work Breakdown Structure

APPENDIX 1: Technology Readiness Level (TRL) Definitions

TRL Definition		Description
1	Basic principles observed and reported.	Lowest level of technology readiness. Scientific research begins to be translated into applied research and development. Examples might include paper studies of a technology's basic properties.
2	Technology concept and/or application formulated.	Invention begins. Once basic principles are observed, practical applications can be invented. Applications are speculative and there may be no proof or detailed analysis to support the assumptions. Examples are limited to analytic studies.
3	Analytical and experimental critical function and/or characteristic proof-of-concept.	Active research and development is initiated. This includes analytical studies and laboratory studies to physically validate analytical predictions of separate elements of the technology. Examples include components that are not yet integrated or representative.
4	Component and/or breadboard validation in laboratory environment.	Basic technological components are integrated to establish that they will work together. This is relatively "low fidelity" compared to the eventual system. Examples include integration of "ad hoc" hardware in the laboratory.
5	Component and/or breadboard validation in relevant environment.	Fidelity of breadboard technology increases significantly. The basic technological components are integrated with reasonably realistic supporting elements so it can be tested in a simulated environment. Examples include "high fidelity" laboratory integration of components.
6	System/subsystem model or prototype demonstration in a relevant environment.	Representative model or prototype system, which is well beyond that of TRL 5, is tested in a relevant environment. Represents a major step up in a technology's demonstrated readiness. Examples include testing a prototype in a high-fidelity laboratory environment or in simulated operational environment.
7	System prototype demonstration in an operational environment.	Prototype near, or at, planned operational system. Represents a major step up from TRL 6, requiring demonstration of an actual system prototype in an operational environment such as an aircraft, vehicle, or space. Examples include testing the prototype in a test bed aircraft.
8	Actual system completed and qualified through test and demonstration.	Technology has been proven to work in its final form and under expected conditions. In almost all cases, this TRL represents the end of true system development. Examples include developmental test and evaluation of the system in its intended weapon system to determine if it meets design specifications.
9	Actual system proven through successful mission operations.	Actual application of the technology in its final form and under mission conditions, such as those encountered in operational test and evaluation. Examples include using the system under operational mission conditions.

END OF BAA ATTACHMENT A